

Chapter-12

Narration

Read the sentences given below.

My father said to me, “**I have to attend a meeting tomorrow.**”

My father told me that **he had to attend a meeting the next day.**

The act of reporting a person’s speech is called Narration. There are two ways of narrating a person’s speech.

Direct Speech: In **Direct Speech**, the actual words spoken by a person are quoted within inverted commas (“.....”). In example 1, the actual words spoken by ‘my father’ are quoted without any change.

Indirect Speech: In **Indirect Speech**, the gist/meaning/matter of the speaker’s words is conveyed without quoting the actual words. In example 2, the meaning of “my father’s” words is conveyed without quoting his actual words.

Two parts of a Direct Speech

- (i) **Reporting Speech:** The part of the sentence outside the inverted commas is called Reporting Speech. It is generally termed as Reporting Verb. It has three parts: Subject, Reporting Verb and Objects. In certain cases the object may be missing.
- (ii) **Reported Speech:** The part of the sentence enclosed within the inverted commas is called the Reported Speech. A Reported Speech also has a Subject and a Verb with other extensions (other parts of speech).

Read the sentences given below carefully and study the structures of a Direct Sentence.

Direct: **My friend said to me**, “I will give you my book.”

Direct: (**Reporting Speech**), “Reported Speech.”

Direct: (**My friend**) (**said**) (**to me**), “I will give you my book.”

Direct: (**Subject**) (**Reporting Verb**) (**Object**), “Subject and Verb of Reported Speech (with other extensions).”

Sentence Structure of an Indirect Speech:

An Indirect Speech is a Complex Sentence made of a Principal Clause (Reporting Speech) and a Subordinate Clause (Reported Speech), generally joined by a conjunction. Look at the following example:

Direct: **My friend said to me**, “I will give you my book.”

Indirect: My friend told me **that** he would give me his book. (Indirect Speech)

(Principal Clause) **Conjunction** (Subordinate Clause)

Sentence Structure of an Indirect Speech:

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
Actual words of the speaker are quoted in inverted commas.	Actual words of the speaker are not quoted. The meaning or matter of the reported speech is conveyed indirectly.
It has two parts: Reporting Verb and Reported Speech	It is one complex sentence with a Principal Clause and a Subordinate Clause.
Reporting Verb and Reported Speech are separated by comma. Reported Speech is enclosed within inverted commas.	There is no use of comma to separate Reporting Verb and Reported Speech. Inverted commas are removed.
Reported Speech in inverted commas starts with a capital letter.	Reported speech becomes the subordinate clause of a Complex Sentence. Hence, it starts with a small letter.
There is no use of Conjunction as Reporting Verb and Reported Speech are separated by a comma and inverted commas.	In most of the cases, Reported speech is introduced by a conjunction.

General Rules for Changing Direct Speech into Indirect Speech

Important Note: General rules are those rules which are always followed while changing a Direct Speech into an Indirect Speech. Both general and specific Rules must be followed while changing a Direct Speech into an Indirect Speech. The specific rules are related to types of sentences. These rules are discussed further in this chapter.

Rule-I Inverted commas are removed.

Rule-II Look at the tense of the reporting verb.

- (a) If the tense of Reporting Verb in Direct Speech is Present or Future Tense, there will be no change in the tense of the Reported Speech while changing the Direct Speech into Indirect Speech.
Direct: The teacher says to the students, “I **have corrected** your notebooks.” (Present Perfect Tense)
Indirect: The teacher tells the students that she **has corrected** their notebooks. (Present Perfect Tense)
- (b) If the tense of Reporting Verb in Direct Speech is Past Tense, follow the rules regarding the change of tense discussed later in this chapter.

Rule-III Rules regarding the change in Personal Pronouns:

Important Note: While changing the Personal Pronouns, the Gender and Case of the Personal Pronouns should be kept the same. Study the table given below.

Personal Pronouns	Nominative Case	Accusative Case	Possessive Case
First Person	I, we	me, us	my, mine, our, ours
Second Person	you, thou	you, thee	your, yours, thine
Third Person	he, she, it, they	him, her, it, them	his, her, hers, its, their, theirs

- (i) Pronouns of the **First Person** in the Reported Speech change according to the **Subject** of the Reporting Verb. The case will remain the same.

Direct: My sister said to me, “I don't want to waste my time”.

My sister (Subject, Third Person) said to me, “**I** (First person, Nominative Case) don't want to waste **my** (First Person, Possessive Case) time.”

Indirect:

My sister told me that **she** (Third person, Nominative Case) did not want to waste **her** (Third Person, Possessive Case) time.

- (ii) Pronouns of the **Second Person** in the Reported Speech change according to the **Object** of the Reporting Verb. The case will remain the same.

Direct: I said to her, “You should do your work.”

I said to **her (Object, Third Person)**, “**You** (Second person, Nominative Case) should do **your** (Second Person, Possessive Case) work.”

Indirect:

I advised **her** that **she** (Third Person, Nominative Case) should do **her** (Third Person, Possessive Case) work.

- (iii) **Pronouns of the Third Person in the Reported Speech remain unchanged.**

Direct: Asha said to me, “**He** (Third Person) is wasting **his** (Third Person) time.”

Indirect: Asha told me that **he** (Third Person) was wasting **his** (Third Person) time.

The following table will help the learners learn the rules of Pronouns:

Reporting Verb	S	O	N
Reported Speech	I	II	III

Here: S = Subject I = First Person
 O = Object II = Second Person
 N = No Change III = Third Person

Rule- IV Subject-verb agreement must be followed when Pronouns or Tense in the Reported Speech is changed.

Direct: I **say** to my friend, “**You are** very intelligent.”

Indirect: I tell my friend that **he is** very intelligent.

Direct: I **said** to my friend, “**You are** very intelligent.”

Indirect: I told my friend that **he was** very intelligent.

Rule-V A conjunction is used to introduce the Reported Speech. The use of conjunction depends on the type of sentence of the Reported Speech. Read the table given below carefully.

Type of Sentence in Reported Speech	Conjunction Used to join Reporting Verb and Reported Speech
Assertive Sentences (Affirmative & Negative)	that
Interrogative Sentences (Single)	if/whether
Interrogative Sentences (Double: with Wh-words)	Wh-word used in the Reported Speech
Imperative Sentences	Infinitive with to/that
Exclamatory Sentences	that
Optative Sentences	that

Rule- VI The tense of Reporting Verb remains the same. If the Reporting Verb is ‘say’, ‘says’, ‘will say’, or ‘said’ it remains the same. If Reporting Verb is followed by ‘to’ and an object, there will be the following changes in the Reporting Verbs if the Reported Speech is an Assertive Sentence. Examples:

say to him	tell him
says to me	tells me
will say to her	will tell her
said to you	told you

Rule- VII Vocatives and Nominative of Address are omitted altogether and their sense expressed in the sentence.

Direct: He said to his boss, “**Sir**, the report is ready.”

Indirect: He told his boss **respectfully** that the report was ready.

Rules Regarding the Change in Tense

Rule-I If the Reporting Verb is in Present Tense or Future Tense, there will be no change in the tense of the Reported Speech.

Direct: My mother says, “The cake **is** delicious.”

Indirect: My mother says that the cake **is** delicious.

Direct: He says to me, “I **am playing** here.”

Indirect: He tells me that he **is playing** here.

Direct: Tarun will say, “I **was reading** a book.”

Indirect: Tarun will say that he **was reading** a book.

Rule-II If the Reporting Verb is in Past Tense the tense of the Reported Speech will change in its corresponding tense in the Past Tense. The following table explains the change in tense.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
Simple Present (V1)	Simple Past (V2)
Present Continuous (is/am/are+ V1+ ing)	Past Continuous (was/were+ V1+ ing)
Present Perfect (has/have+V3)	Past Perfect (had+V3)
Present Perfect Continuous (has/have +been+ V1+ing)	Past Perfect Continuous (had+ been+ V1+ing)
Simple Past (V2)	Past Perfect (had+V3)
Past Continuous (was/were+ V1+ ing)	Past Perfect Continuous (had +been+ V1+ing)
Past Perfect (had+V3)	Past Perfect (had+V3)
Past Perfect Continuous (had +been+ V1+ing)	Past Perfect Continuous (had +been+ V1+ing)
Simple Future (will/shall+V1)	Past form of Simple Future (would+ V1)
Future Continuous (will/shall+be+V1+ing)	Past form of Future Continuous (would+be+V1+ing)
Future Perfect (will/shall+ have+ V3)	Past form of Future Perfect (would+have+V3)
Future Perfect Continuous (will/shall+ have+ been+ V1+ing)	Past form of Future Perfect Continuous (would+ have+ been+ V1+ing)

Direct: My mother said, “The food **is** tasty.”

Indirect: My mother said that the food **was** tasty.

Direct: He said to me, “I **am** playing here.”

Indirect: He told me that he **was** playing there.

Direct: John said, “The baby **was** sleeping.”

Indirect: John said that the baby **had been** sleeping.

Direct: My sister said to me, “I **don't** like apples.”

Indirect: My sister told me that she **did not** like apples.

Rule-III Modal Auxiliaries are changed according to the table given below.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
can	could
shall	should/would
will	would
may	might
could/should/would/might	no change

Rule-IV Change of ‘Must’:

(i) If must indicates future necessity or compulsion, it changes into would+have+to+V1 (Conditional)

Direct: He said, “I **must** finish this work by tomorrow.”

Indirect: He said that he **would have to** finish that work by the next day.

(ii) For immediate necessity, 'must' is changed into 'had to'.

Direct: He said, “I **must** go home now.”

Indirect: He said that he **had to** go home then.

(iii) When 'must' indicates permanent rule, advice, prohibition etc, it does not change.

Direct: The teacher said, “The students **must** not miss my class.”

Indirect: The teacher said that the students **must** not miss her class.

Rule-V Change of Modal Auxiliaries ‘Need’ and ‘Dare’:

Direct: He said to me, “You **need not** wait for me.”

Indirect: He told me that I **need not** wait for him.

Or,

Indirect: He told me that I **did not need to** wait for him.

Direct: He said to me, “I **dare not talk** to the boss.”

Indirect: He told me that he **dare not talk** to the boss.

Or,

Indirect: He told me that he **did not dare to talk** to the boss.

Rule-VI Adverbs of Time and Place and some other words are changed according to the table given below. If the tense of the Reported Speech is not changed, the adverbials of time and place are also not changed.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
this	that
these	those
here, hither	there, thither
hence, hereby	thence, thereby
come	go
now	then
today	that day
tonight	that night
yesterday	the previous day
last week/month/year	the previous week/month/year
last night	the night before
tomorrow	the next day/the following year
ago	before
thus	so
the last fortnight	the previous fortnight
the day before yesterday	the day before the previous day
the next week/month/year	the following week/month/year

Situations When the Tense of Reported Speech Remains the Same

There are a few exceptional situations when the tense of the Reported Speech is not changed even if the Reporting Verb is in the Past Tense.

- (a) If the Reported Speech is a Universal Truth, a Mathematical fact, Geographical fact, Historical fact, Chemical fact or some other fact, the tense is not changed.

Examples:

Direct: The teacher said, “The sun **rises** in the east.”

Indirect: The teacher said that the sun **rises** in the east.

Direct: He said to me, “Two and two **make** four.”

Indirect: He told me that two and two **make** four.

Direct: He said to me, “Water **freezes** at 0° Celsius.”

Indirect: He told me that water **freezes** at 0° Celsius.

Direct: He said to me, “The Red Fort **is** in Delhi.”

Indirect: He told me that the Red Fort **is** in Delhi.

(b) If the Reported Speech is a Proverb or an act of morality, the tense is not changed.

Example:

Direct: Riya said to her brother, “A burnt child dreads the fire.”

Indirect: Riya told her brother that a burnt child dreads the fire.

(c) If the Reported Speech explains some Habitual Act of Present, the tense is not changed.

Examples:

Direct: The teacher said, “Mohan always **comes** late.”

Indirect: The teacher said the Mohan always **comes** late. (He still comes late.)

Direct: He said to me, “My mother **goes** to temple every day.”

Indirect: He told me that his mother **goes** to temple every day. (Present habit)

(d) If the Reported Speech refers to past time/date/year, the tense is not changed.

Example:

Direct: My mother said to me, “India **got** freedom on 15th August 1947.”

Indirect: My mother told me that India **got** freedom on 15th August 1947.

(e) If the Reported Speech expresses two simultaneous actions, the tense remains the same.

Examples:

Direct: He said to me, I **studied** when my brother **played**.”

Indirect: He told me that he **studied** when his brother **played**.

Direct: He said to me, I **was completing** my homework when my father **was watching** TV.”

Indirect: He told me that he **was completing** his homework when his father **was watching** TV.

(f) If the action expressed in the Reported Speech continues at the time of Reporting, the tense is not changed.

Examples:

Direct: He said to me, “Prices **are going** up.”

Indirect: He told me that prices **are going** up.

Direct: He said to me, “India **is progressing** by leaps and bounds.”

Indirect: He told me that India **is progressing** by leaps and bounds.

(g) If the Reported Speech expresses an imaginary condition or an unreal condition, the tense is not changed.

Examples:

Direct: He said, “If my son **were** here, I **would be** very happy.”

Indirect: He said that if his son **were** there, he **would be** very happy.

Direct: He said to me, “If you **had invited** me, I **would have attended** the party.”

Indirect: He told me that if I **had invited** me, he **would have attended** the party.

Direct: He said, “It is high time we **started** our journey.”

Indirect: He said that it was high time they **started** their journey.

Specific Rules According to Types of Sentences

There are different rules for different types of sentences for changing a Direct Speech into an Indirect Speech. Therefore, it is very important to find out what type of sentence a Reported Speech is. A Reported Speech in a Direct Speech may be-

1. Assertive Sentence
2. Interrogative Sentence
3. Imperative Sentence
4. Exclamatory Sentence
5. Optative Sentence

Rules/Instructions for Changing Assertive Sentences

Assertive Sentences are simple statements. There are two types: Affirmative Sentences and Negative Sentences.

1. Remove inverted commas and use the conjunction 'that' to join the Reporting Speech and the Reported Speech. Change Reporting Verb as explained under Rule-VI of general rules.
2. Change Personal Pronouns according to General rules.
3. Follow Tense related rules to change or not to change the Tense.
4. Adverbs of time and place and other words are changed as explained under Rule-VI of changing tense.

Direct: He said, "I **am reading** a book."

Indirect: He said **that** he **was reading** a book.

Direct: My friend said to me, "I **have solved** the sum."

Indirect: My friend told me **that** he **had solved** the sum.

Direct: He said to me, "I **cannot** explain the situation now."

Indirect: He told me **that** he **could not** explain the situation then.

Direct: She said to me, "I **was** waiting for you."

Indirect: She told me **that** she **had been** waiting for me.

Direct: My brother said to me, "I **will** work hard to win the gold medal in the race."

Indirect: My brother told me **that** he **would** work hard to win the gold medal in the race.

Practice Exercise-I

1. The captain said to players, "In case of rain we will cancel the match."

2. My friend said to me, "You can take my book if you want to study."

3. My neighbour said to me, "Someone has stolen my camera."

4. His brother said to him, "I am going to watch a movie now."

5. Riya said to me, "I shall go to Mumbai the next week."

6. She said to me, "I will be playing cricket in the evening."

7. The teacher said, "The earth revolves around the sun."

8. Rajat said to her, "I returned your book last week."

9. My sister said to me, "The police will have caught the thief."

10. The teacher said to the students, "You must attend your classes regularly."

11. The professor said, "Pollution is increasing day by day."

12. My father said to me, "If you had worked hard, you would have succeeded."

13. My friend said to me, "We finish our work soon."

14. My brother said to me, "The weather is pleasant today."

15. The stranger said to me, "I have lived in Tamil Nadu for ten years."

Practice Exercise-II

1. My father said, "A little knowledge is a dangerous thing."

2. My friend said to me, "You always keep your things scattered here and there."

3. My friend said to me, "Mahatma Gandhi was born on 2nd October 1869."

4. The teacher said to the students, "You need not bring your books tomorrow."

5. His brother said to him, "I watered the plants when you studied."

6. Riya said to me, "All is well that ends well."

7. The soldier said, "We ought to serve our country."

8. She says to me, "I will be playing football in the evening."

9. He said to his mother, "You do not need to worry about me."

10. Rohan will say to him, "I returned your book last week."

11. My sister has said to me, "I have to clean the house by evening."

12. I said to my classmate, "I have never told a lie."

13. The teacher said to the students, "The First battle of Panipat was fought in 1526."

14. The inspector said to me, "You must wear a helmet while riding a motorcycle."

15. My friend said to me, "If I were you, I would buy this car."

Rules/Instructions for Changing Interrogative Sentences

Interrogative Sentences are questions. There are two types of Interrogative Sentences.

(a) Single Interrogative Sentence: It starts with a Primary Auxiliary or a Modal Auxiliary. Such sentences are answered in 'Yes' or 'No'.

Examples: (i) Are you a teacher? Yes/No (ii) Will you marry me? Yes/No

(b) Double Interrogative Sentence: It starts with a 'Wh-word' (Interrogative Pronoun or Interrogative Adverb).

Examples: (i) What is your name? (ii) Who are you? (iii) Where are you going?

1. Change the reporting verb into ask/asked, enquire/enquired, or wonder/wondered etc.
2. Remove inverted commas. If the Reported Speech is a Single Interrogative Sentence, use the conjunction 'if' or 'whether' to join the Reporting Speech and the Reported Speech.
3. If the Reported Speech is a Double Interrogative Sentence, use the Wh-word given in the Reported Speech as a conjunction.
4. Follow the rules of Pronouns and Tenses.
5. In Indirect Speech, Interrogative Sentence, given in the Reported Speech, changes into an Assertive Sentence. Therefore, the places of Subject and Verb are exchanged. This is known as Inversion. Sign of Interrogation (?) is removed.

Example: Is **he** your friend? (Interrogative Sentence)

He is your friend. (Assertive Sentence)

6. Helping verbs: 'do', 'does', or 'did' are removed.

Direct: He said to me, “**Do you live** in Chandigarh?”

Indirect: He asked me **if I lived** in Chandigarh.

Direct: He said to me, “**When are you** going to Delhi?”

Indirect: He asked me **when I was** going to Delhi.

Direct: The teacher said to the students, “**Who has broken** the window?”

Indirect: The teacher asked the students **who had broken** the windows.

Direct: She said to me, “**Shall I** open the door?”

Indirect: She asked me **if she should** open the door.

Direct: My father said to me, “**Have you** taken my pen?”

Indirect: My father asked me **if I had** taken his pen.

Direct: My sister said to me, “**Why are you** troubling me?”

Indirect: My sister asked me **why I was** troubling her.

Questions Starting with Shall I/We

1. If 'shall' indicates Future Tense or some information/speculation, it changes into 'would'.

Direct: He said to me, “**Shall** we ever meet again?”

Indirect: He wondered **if we would** ever meet again.

2. If 'shall' indicates seeking advice or a request, it changes into 'should'

Direct: Ritu said, “**Shall** I open the door?”

Indirect: Ritu asked **if she should** open the door.

3. If 'shall' indicates an offer, it is replaced with the verb 'offer'.

Direct: She said to me, “**Shall** I bring you something to eat?”

Indirect: She **offered** to bring me something to eat.

4. If 'shall' indicates a suggestion, it is replaced with the verb 'suggest'.

Direct: He said, “**Shall** we meet again tomorrow?”

Indirect: He **suggested** meeting again the next day.

Questions Starting with Will you/ would you/ could you

1. If the questions starting with 'will you', 'would you' or 'could you' are ordinary questions, the rules of single interrogative sentences will be applied.
2. If the questions starting with 'will you', 'would you' or 'could you' indicate an order, request or offer, the changes will be made accordingly as explained in the following examples.

Direct: He shouted, "Will you keep silence?" (order)

Indirect: He **ordered** me to keep silence.

Direct: She said to me, "Could you give me some sugar?" (request)

Indirect: She **requested** me to give her some sugar.

Direct: She said to me, "Would you like to have a drink?" (offer)

Indirect: She **invited** me for a drink. Or, She **offered** me a drink.

Practice Exercise-III

1. My mother said to my sister, "Why have you not completed your homework?"

.....

2. He said to his guests, "Shall I make you a cup of tea?"

.....

3. The secretary said to the visitor, "Whom do you want to see?"

.....

4. He said to me, "Are you watering the plants?"

.....

5. The student said to the teacher, "May I come in?"

.....

6. My uncle said to me, "When does the postman come every day?"

.....

7. The shopkeeper said to the boy, "What do you want to buy?"

.....

8. The student said to the teacher, "Can you explain the sum again?"

.....

9. The father said to his son, "Where have you kept my spectacles?"

.....

10. The teacher said to the student, "Why have you come late today?"

.....

11. I said to him, "When are you going to your office?"

.....

12. She said to him, "Do you know who I am?"

.....

13. The stranger said to me, "Could you tell me the way to railway station?"

14. Rajat said to his brother, "Why don't you listen to me?"

15. She said to her, "Did he not care for you?"

Rules/Instructions for Changing Imperative Sentences

Imperative Sentences express an order, command, request, prohibition or advice. These sentences start directly with the first form of Verb or 'Don't', followed by the first form of Verb.

1. Change the Reporting Verb in order/ordered, request/requested, command/commanded, forbid/forbade, advise/advised, or beg/begged according to the meaning implied in the Reported Speech.
2. The Imperative Mood is changed into Infinitive Mood.
3. Change the first form of verb into Positive Infinitive (to+V1) and 'Don't+ V1' into Negative Infinitive (not+to+V1). For Negative Infinitive, the verb 'Forbid' can also be used.

Direct: The boss said to his employee, "**Show** me the report."

Indirect: The boss ordered his employee **to show** him the report.

Direct: My father said to me, "**Take** care of your health."

Indirect: My father advised me **to take** care of my health.

Direct: My sisters said to me, "Please, **don't disturb** me."

Indirect: My sister requested me **not to disturb** her.

Direct: The Commander said to the soldiers, "**Don't be afraid** of the enemy. Move forward."

Indirect: The Commander commanded the soldiers **not to be afraid** of the enemy and to move forward.

Direct: The gardener said to the boys, "**Don't pluck** the flowers."

Indirect: The gardener **forbade** the boys to pluck the flowers.

Direct: He said to me, "**Beware of** false friends."

Indirect: He **warned** me **against** false friends.

Practice Exercise- IV

1. He said to his son, "Never tell a lie."

2. The Principal said to the peon, "Bring that parcel to me."

3. The captain said to the soldiers, "Fire at the enemy."

4. The teacher said to the students, "Don't make a noise."

5. The Principal said to the boys, "Work hard if you want to succeed."

6. My mother said to me, “Clean your room and arrange your books.”

7. The beggar said to the shopkeeper, “Please give me a rupee.”

8. My brother said to me, “Don’t touch my things.”

9. He said to me, “Wait here till I come back.”

10. The student said to the teacher, “Please correct my notebook.”

Rules/Instructions for Changing Exclamatory Sentences

Exclamatory Sentences express a sudden or a strong feeling. These sentences start with an Interjection such as 'Hurrah', 'Alas', 'Oh' etc or 'What'/ 'How'.

- 1. The Exclamatory Sentence is changed into Assertive Sentence.
- 2. The Reporting Verb is changed into exclaimed or exclaimed with (Joy, sorrow, wonder etc according to the Interjection given in the Direct Speech).
- 3. Conjunction 'that' is used to join the Reporting Verb and the Reported Speech.
- 4. Interjection' or any other exclamatory word is removed.
- 5. All the rules of Pronouns and Tenses are followed.
- 6. Mark of exclamation is removed.

Points to remember

Ho! Hurrah! Hoo!	express	joy or delight
What! Oh! Good Heavens	express	wonder/surprise
Alas! Ah! Oh! Sorry!	express	grief, pain or regret
Hark! Hush! Lo! Behold!	express	attention
Pooh! Pshaw!	express	contempt
Damn!	expresses	swear
Bravo!	expresses	applause/encouragement
Nonsense!	expresses	anger/disappointment
Fie! Shame!	express	shame or reproof

Direct: She said, “Alas! I have injured my hand.”

Indirect: She exclaimed with sorrow that she had injured her hand.

Direct: The players said, “Hurrah! We have won the match.”

Indirect: The players exclaimed with joy that they had won the match.

Direct: The captain said to the players, “Bravo! You played very well today.”

Indirect: The captain applauded the players saying that they had played very well that day.

Direct: She said, “How beautiful the scenery is!”

Indirect: She exclaimed that the scenery was very beautiful.

Direct: She said, “How foolish I have been!”

Indirect: She confessed that she had been very foolish.

Practice Exercise - V

1. The students said, "How difficult the question paper is!"

.....

2. She said to her son, "Hush! The baby is sleeping."

.....

3. He said, "What beautiful scenery!"

.....

4. My friend said to me, "How nice of you to have come!"

.....

5. She said, "Hurrah! My brother has won a lottery prize."

.....

6. The boy said, "Oh! I have forgotten my book at home."

.....

7. I said, "What a difficult tongue twister!"

.....

8. My brother said, "Hurrah! I have got the first rank in my class."

.....

9. He said, "Alas! I have lost my son."

.....

10. He said to the boy, "Pooh! Pooh! What a dirty fellow you are!"

.....

11. She said to the beggar, "How shabbily dressed up you are!"

.....

12. The child said to the old man, "How old you are!"

.....

13. The commander said to the soldier, "Bravo! Good shot."

.....

14. He said, "What a terrible storm!"

.....

15. We said, "What a nice place this is!"

.....

Rules/Instructions for Changing Optative Sentences

Optative Sentences express a wish, desire, blessing, prayer or curse. The use of Modal Auxiliaries 'May' and 'Would' is common in these sentences. Conditional sentences using 'were' are also used to express a wish.

1. Reporting verb is changed into wished/prayed/ desired/cursed etc.
2. The word 'wish' used in the Direct Speech is removed.
3. If the Reporting Verb is in Past Tense, 'May' is used into 'Might'.
4. 'Were' used in Conditional Sentences is changed into 'had been' if the Reporting Verb is in Past Tense.
5. We wish good morning, good afternoon, good evening or good night.
6. We bid welcome, farewell or good-bye.

Direct: He said to me, "May you get success in life."

Indirect: He wished that I might get success in life.

Direct: He said, "Good morning, teacher."

Indirect: He wished good morning to his teacher.

Direct: She said, "Good bye, friends."

Indirect: She bade farewell to her friends.

Direct: He said, "O for a glass of water!"

Indirect: He desired strongly for a glass of water.

Direct: He said, "May God save the king."

Indirect: He prayed that God might save the king.

Practice Exercise - VI

1. He said to the patient, "May you recover soon!"

.....

2. He said, "O for a cup of tea!"

.....

3. I said to her, "Happy Christmas!"

.....

4. They said to the chief guest, "Welcome!"

.....

5. He said, "May God grant peace to the departed soul."

.....

6. I said to my parents, "Good Morning!"

.....

7. The teacher said to the students, "May you all fare well in your examination."

.....

8. I said to my friend, "May you get success in life."

.....

9. My friend said to me, "Good luck to you!"

.....

10. John said, "O for a house to live in."

.....

Practice Exercise - VII

1. My mother said to me, "Might is right."

.....

2. He said to me, "Have you received the parcel?"

.....

3. The young man said, "I have purchased a new house."

.....

4. The teacher said, "The British ruled over India for two hundred years."

.....

5. My friend said to me, "I read an interesting novel last week."

.....

6. My teacher said, "Corruption is in the air these days."

.....

7. The Principal said to the teacher, "Were you present at the meeting?"

.....

8. I said to him, "Where will you park my car?"

.....

9. The teacher said to the students, "Why are you making a noise?"

.....

10. My father said to me, "Clean your room right now."

.....

11. His brother said to him, "Don't waste your time."

.....

12. My sister said, "What a beautiful dress!"

.....

13. The daughter said to her mother, "What have you prepared in lunch."

.....

14. The boy said to the old man, "How old you are!"

.....

15. The old man said to the boy, "How old are you?"

.....